

Microsoft is now a part of the Cloud Native Computing Foundation

Continuing its developments around open source, Microsoft has now joined the Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF). The latest announcement comes days after the Redmond company entered the board of the Cloud Foundry Foundation.

"Joining the Cloud Native Computing Foundation is another natural step on our open source journey, and we look forward to learning and engaging with the community on a deeper level as a CNCF member," said Corey Sanders, partner director, Microsoft, in a joint statement.

Microsoft has chosen the Platinum membership of the CNCF. Gabe Monroy, a lead product manager for containers on Microsoft Azure and former Deis CTO, is joining CNCF's governing board.

Led by the core team members of the Linux Foundation, CNCF has welcomed the new move of Microsoft. The non-profit organisation considers it a "testament to the importance and growth" of cloud technologies and believes the Windows maker's commitment to open source infrastructure is a 'significant asset' to its board.

"We are honoured to have Microsoft, widely recognised as one of the most important enterprise technology and cloud providers in the world, join CNCF as a platinum member. Its membership, along with other global cloud providers that also belong to CNCF, is a testament to the importance and growth of cloud native technologies," stated Dan Kohn, executive director of the Cloud Native Computing Foundation.

"We hope these improvements will help you make your first contribution, start a new project, or grow your community," GitHub concluded in its blog.

First launched in October 2007, GitHub is so far used by more than 23 million people around the globe. The platform hosts over 63 million projects with a worldwide employee base of 668 people.

Mozilla aims to enhance AI developments with open source human voices

While elite digital assistants like Alexa, Cortana, Google Assistant and Siri have



so far been receiving inputs from users via the spoken word, Mozilla is planning to enhance all such existing artificial intelligence (AI) developments by open sourcing human voices on a mass level. The Web giant has already launched a project called Common Voice to build a large-scale repository of voice recordings for future use.

Mozilla has started capturing human voices since June to build its open source database. The database will be live later this year to "let anyone quickly and easily train voice-enabled apps" that go beyond Alexa, Google Assistant and Siri.

"Experts think voice recognition applications represent the 'next big thing'. The problem is the current ecosystem favours Big Tech and leaves out the next wave of innovators," said Daniel Kessler, senior brand manager, Mozilla, in a recent blog post.

Tech companies are presently using different voices to teach computers to understand the variety of languages for their solutions. But the data sets with the voice collections are mostly proprietary as of now. Therefore, a large number of developers have no access to voice recording samples to test their own voice recognition projects. This ultimately leads to a limited number of apps understanding our speech.

Things are appearing to be changing with Common Voice. "The time has come for an open source data set that can change the game. The time is right for Project Common Voice," Kessler stated. Mozilla is asking individuals to donate their voice recordings either on the Common Voice Web page or by downloading a dedicated iOS app. Once you are ready with your recording, you need to read a set of sentences that will be saved into the system.

The recorded voices, which would come in a variety of languages with various accents and demographics, will be provided to third-party developers.

In addition to simply receiving voice donations, Mozilla has built a model by which users will validate the recordings that are stored in the system. This process will help train an app's speech-to-text conversion capabilities.

All this will enable not just one or two but 10,000 hours of validated audio that will power tons of AI models in the near future. Notably, recordings received through the Common Voice initiative will be integrated into the Firefox browser as well. But the main purpose of this exercise is to provide a public resource.

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